

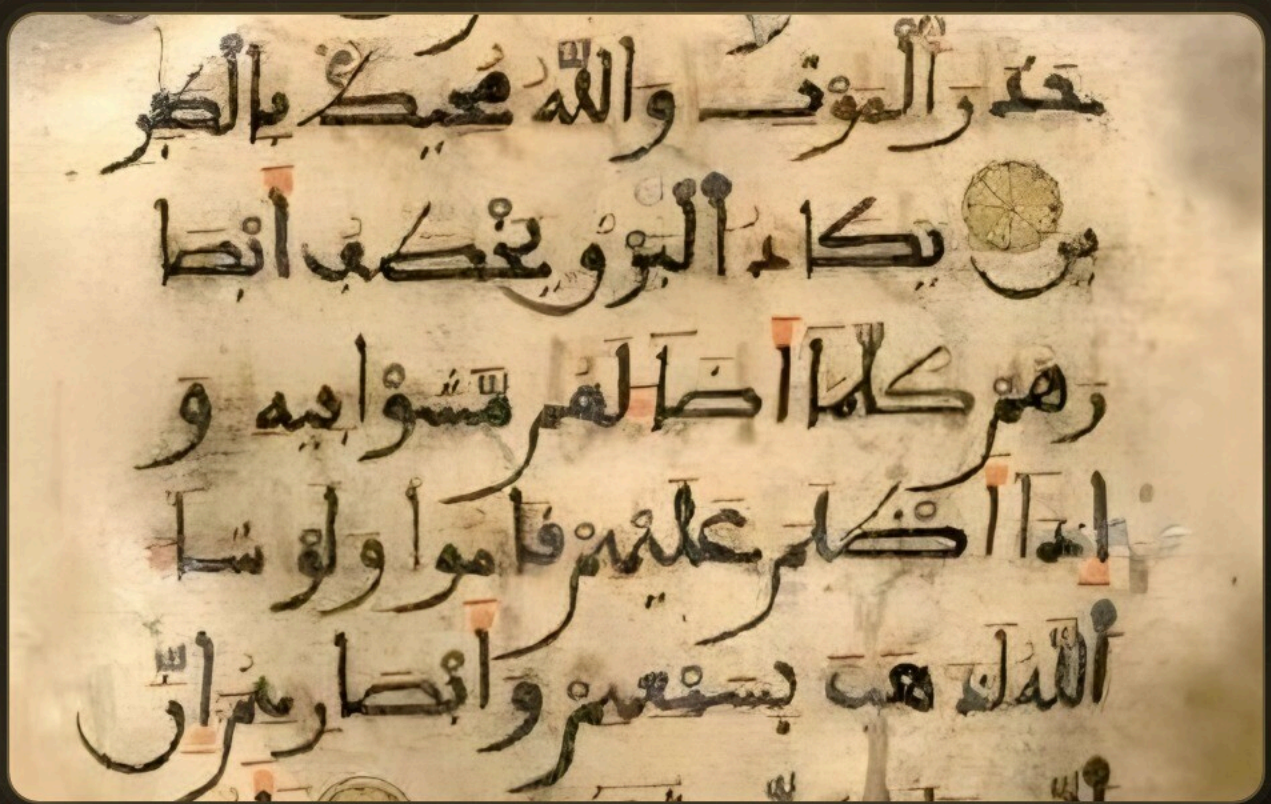
Five treasures of Moroccan Qur’an manuscripts

From Marrakesh and Rabat to Jerusalem, El Escorial and Munich

Swipe →

ALMOHADS · 654 AH / 1256 CE

The rabʿa of the Caliph al-Murtada, in his own hand



Copied by the Almohad caliph Abu Hafs ʿUmar al-Murtada himself, in Marrakesh. The colophon of volume 2 reads: “written by his own mortal hand.”

Today: Ibn Yusuf Library, Marrakesh, and the National Library, Rabat

Image: Ibn Yusuf Library 432/1 (vol. 1), after Dr Mohamed Abdelhafid Khabta

MARINIDS · 705 AH / 1306 CE

The Qur’an of Sultan Abu Yaʿqub Yusuf



Written on parchment for the Marinid sultan’s library, in twelve volumes. Only the first and the last survive.

Today: Munich, Bavarian State Library

Image: Bavarian State Library, Cod.arab. 2, public domain

MARINIDS · 745 AH / 1344–1345 CE

The Maghribi rabʿa of Sultan Abu al-Hasan



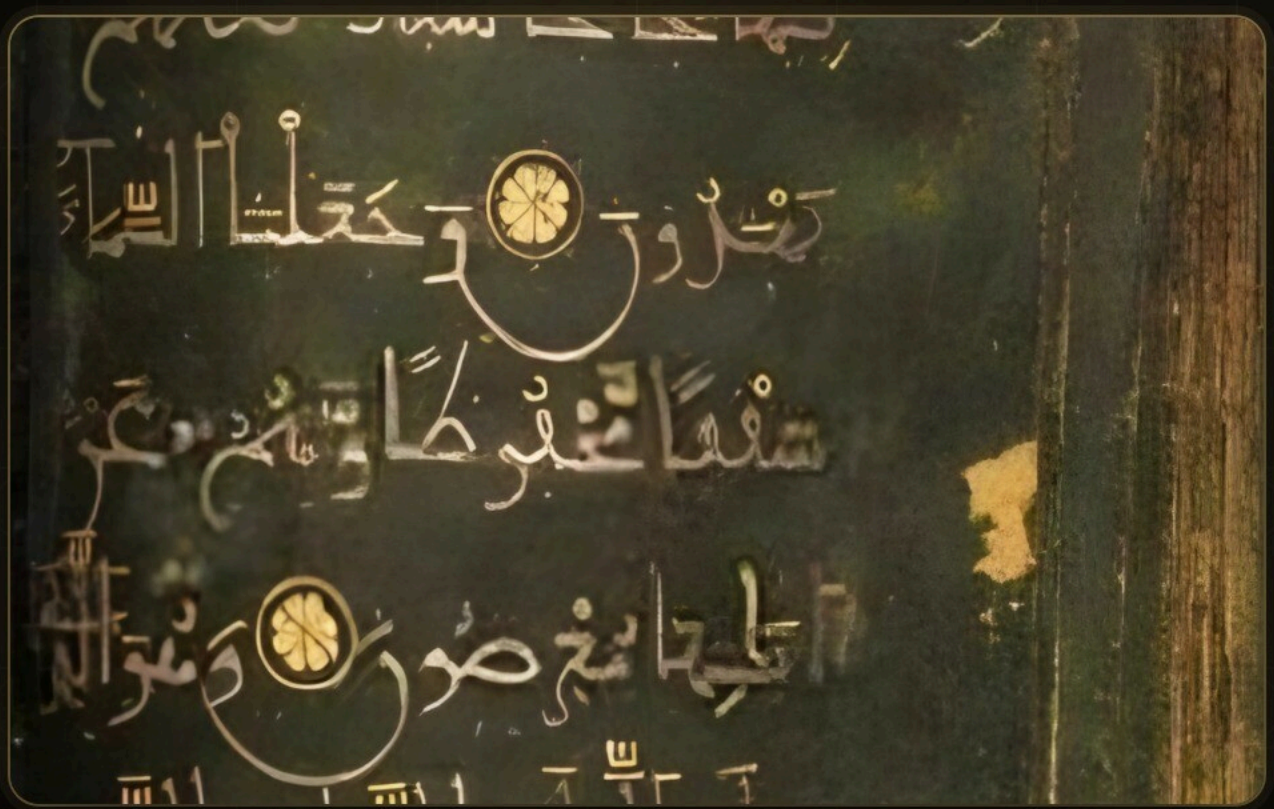
Copied by the Marinid sultan in his own hand and endowed to al-Aqsa Mosque. Twenty-five of its thirty volumes in his hand survive.

Today: Jerusalem, Islamic Museum of al-Aqsa Mosque

Image: after Dr Mohamed Abdelhafid Khabta, at low resolution

WATTASIDS · 9th century AH

The Green Qur’an



Its paper is dyed entirely green, so that none of its natural colour shows, and the text is written in silver. It is attributed to the Wattasid period.

Today: Rabat, National Library

Image: National Library, Rabat, 1304, after Dr Mohamed Abdelhafid Khabta

SAADIANS · 1008 AH / 1599 CE

The Qur’an of Sultan Ahmad al-Mansur



Written for al-Mansur’s library, in the mosque of his palaces in Marrakesh. Its colophon is in gold on lapis blue.

Today: El Escorial, Royal Library

Image: Patrimonio Nacional, Real Biblioteca del Monasterio de El Escorial, Árabe 1340

Masahif al-Maghrib

An illustrated guide to the dated Qur'ans of Morocco, from the Idrisids to the Alaouites

12 CENTURIES

7 DYNASTIES

60+ QUR'ANS

Idrisids · Almoravids · Almohads · Marinids · Wattasids · Saadians · Alaouites

Prepared by calligrapher and manuscript researcher **Ibrahim Hassani Idrissi**

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